MEETING OR CONTACT REPORT

	Date of Report: October 8, 1958
Organization & Location: IBM - Poughkeepsie	Date: October 6, 1958
	Reported By: R. P. Polivka
Project: Preliminary Meeting in Preparation for the Los Alamos Discussions, October 8-10.	Department: 539
	Follow-up Date:

PERSONNEL PARTICIPATING:
(Place asterisk next to those on distribution list. Other distribution show at end of report)

Miss E. McDonough
Messrs. W. P. Heising
G. Grover
F. P. Brooks
E. F. Codd
P. S. Herwitz
H. G. Kolsky ←
C. T. Apple
R. P. Polivka
C. L. Gerberich
E. W. Coffin

Agenda:
1. Data definition in STRAP 1 and 2
2. Supervisory program work
3. Subroutine conventions
4. Memo on STRAP 1 specifications

The meeting began with presentations of material which will be discussed at the Los Alamos meeting.

Mr. Grover presented his proposals on data definition in STRAP 1 and 2. Briefly the scheme for defining data has the following appearance:

$$XXXX\ (D_1)\ I_1, \ldots . I_k, \ (D_2)\ I_{k+1} \ldots .$$

where

XXXX indicates the forms of data definition,
e.g., DD : Data definition,
CDD : Computed data definition,
DR : Data reservation;

(D_1) specifies the type of data, e.g., floating point or VFL;

(D_i), ($i>1$) specifies just the changes in the data from the preceeding data;

"I_k" represents the data, and other pertinent information, e.g., contents of sign byte.

The details of Mr. Grover's work will be appended to STRAP 1.

Mr. T. Apple presented his work on the supervisory programs. He is currently working on the primitive supervisory program which consists of a binary loader and a binary dump. He hopes to have it written around the first of the year. With this program Mr. Apple will debug the unisupervisor program. He plans to get out a typed memo concerning the details of his work.

Conventions for operating subroutines were discussed by Mr. E. F. Codd. He explained the list of conventions for operating unshared subroutines which he distributed and will present to the Los Alamos people.

The final point of the agenda was a discussion of the memo dated September 25, 1958, from F. P. Brooks to W. P. Heising on STRAP 1 specifications. The discussion centered around the comments at the end of the memo.

With regard to comments 4 and 5, Applied Programming pointed out that it was Los Alamos that desired this convention. Furthermore, since it had been discussed twice before with them and overwhelmingly approved, there was no need to bring it up again.

Comments 2 and 7 brought out no strong feelings. In light of the conventions of STRAP 1, it was agreed that COUNT, REFILL AND BRANCH is consistent. However, since the conventions themselves are in dispute, this point could not be resolved. There is a possibility that LF and LDF will replace LWF and LDWF.

The modifier principle (comment 9) was roundly discussed. There exists strong feeling among the majority in attendance for the proposal that the modifier be separated from the operation mnemonics and enclosed in parentheses. Mr. Heising and Mr. Grover felt that the discussion ensuing from a reopening of the modifier principle would greatly defer considerations of the many unresolved problems. They felt that since the system appears workable, and further, since Los Alamos is agreeable to it, it would not be worthwhile reopening the discussion on this point.

Two procedural proposals were put forth by Mr. Codd. He suggested first that the modifier principle be discussed on a time-shared basis. This being rejected, he then proposed that the Los Alamos people be approached informally in advance of the meeting as to their feelings about reopening discussion on this point to ascertain the amount of resulting discussion. This, too, was rejected. Furthermore, in any discussion with Los Alamos, Mr. Heising would oppose any change in STRAP 1 on this point. The modifier principle remains unresolved with the "status quo" in force.

The LOAD-FILL, STORE-PRESERVE, and INCREMENT-ADD controversy also remains unresolved . The merit of PRESERVE, in particular, was questioned. PLACE was offered as a possible replacement. However, the meeting ended without any resolution here.

Comment 6 was not discussed.

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RPP/pkb

Distribution:

Dr. G. A. Blaauw
Dr. W. Buchholz
Mr. L. L. Briner
Mr. S. W. Dunwell
Mr. J. C. Gibson
Mr. D. W. Sweeney
Attendance